

Layers Panel Reference

FDD 7.1 · DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS

NAME

DATE



New Layer

Adds a new top-level layer to organize objects into. Double-click its name to rename it, always use a real name, never leave it as "Layer 1."



Sublayer

Every path, group, or object automatically gets its own sublayer nested inside its layer. Expand the disclosure triangle to see and rename them.



Reorder (Stacking Order)

Drag a layer or sublayer up or down in the panel list. Higher in the list = further in front, visually.



Lock / Unlock

Click the lock column to prevent a layer from being accidentally selected or edited. Click again to unlock it.



Show / Hide

Click the eye icon to temporarily hide a layer's contents from view (and from printing/export) without deleting anything.



Merge Selected vs. Flatten Artwork

Merge Selected combines only the layers you've selected, keeping stacking order intact. **Flatten Artwork** collapses the entire document into one layer. Use it only when you're completely done organizing.

Reminder: the target icon on the far right of a layer's row selects every object in that layer at once, useful before locking, hiding, or moving a whole group.